

software support for the medium to long term, continuing to benefit from new features, performance improvements and security patches well beyond its purchase date.

BATTERY LIFE

The iPhone 17e carries a 4,005 mAh battery, the smallest in its price class by some margin. In our PCMark Work 3.0 battery test it ran for 19 hours which is a respectable result relative to the capacity and a reflection of Apple's strength in hardware-software efficiency. In real-world moderate use, calls, social media, streaming and navigation through a typical day, the phone reliably reaches evening with charge remaining.

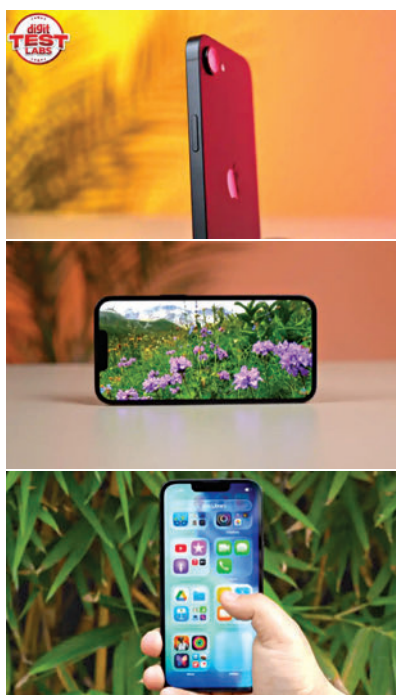
Heavy users will find themselves reaching for a cable by the end of the day. Lighter users will stretch to the following morning without discomfort. Charging is rated at 15 W via Mag-Safe and Qi2 wireless. A full charge takes approximately one hour and 30 minutes. The wireless charging support is a useful convenience in daily use; dropping the phone on a MagSafe puck before bed or during desk sessions is a friction-free routine that wired-only phones cannot offer. The absence of a charger in the box remains a genuine inconvenience, requiring either a USB-C power adapter or a separate purchase for buyers who do not already have one.

The 15W wired charging speed is slow by any current standard. At Rs 64,900, rivals offer 30W, 65W, 80W and above.

CAMERAS

The iPhone 17e has a single 48 MP main camera. There is no ultrawide. There is no telephoto. This is a deliberate simplification at a price point where dual and triple camera systems have become standard and it is the camera section's central context for everything that follows.

Apple's camera processing on the primary sensor is refined and immediately appealing. The results are warm, bright and flattering, images that look good without adjustment and are



ready to be shared without editing. For users who want a camera that reliably produces pleasing results under most conditions without requiring thought or post-processing, the 17e delivers on that promise consistently.

In good light, the 17e's HDR processing takes an aggressive approach to shadow recovery, lifting the darker areas of a scene to produce images that are uniformly well-exposed across their full tonal range. The results are bright and detailed, with strong recovery in areas that other cameras might allow to fall into shade. The trade-off is a slightly flatter overall contrast and images can appear more uniform and less dramatic than those from cameras that preserve deeper shadows. In fine detail, the rendering is slightly softer at a pixel level than more aggressively sharpened alternatives, producing an image quality that reads as natural rather than highly processed.

The iPhone 17e's colour signature leans consistently warm, pulling slightly toward golden and yellow tones across a range of subjects. This reads as appealing in most everyday scenarios: food, people and landscapes in warm

light all benefit from the treatment. In more neutral lighting, the warmth is gentle enough not to be intrusive. On saturated subjects in bright light, particularly highly saturated reds, the camera can occasionally clip highlights more readily than cooler-processed alternatives, with delicate gradient detail in petals and similar subjects occasionally being simplified. Greens tend toward slightly more yellow than their real-world equivalents, which is a consistent trait of the colour tuning.

Portrait processing on the iPhone 17e is optimised for an immediately pleasing result. The camera lifts shadow detail on faces, adds a touch of warmth and softens ambient contrast. For casual portraits, social media content and video calls, this is the right call and Apple executes it well. Skin tones are rendered with warmth and consistency. Edge detection in Portrait mode is reliable in good light, cleanly separating subject from background with accurate depth simulation.

VERDICT

The iPhone 17e is a phone with a clear buyer and an honest proposition. For someone already inside the Apple ecosystem, with AirPods, a Mac and the accumulated frictionlessness that comes from years of iOS use, the Rs 64,900 asking price is a justifiable cost for the most powerful chip at this price, a software experience that has no real competitor in polish and integration like no other.

—Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

SoC: Apple A19 | RAM: 8 GB | Storage: 256/512 GB | Display: 6.1-inch Super Retina XDR OLED | Brightness: 2300 nits | Refresh Rate: 60 Hz | Camera (Rear): 48 MP Fusion Camera | Camera (Front): 12 MP | Weight: 169 g

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